

C2 Advanced English: Homework One

Introduction

Welcome to Homework One, designed for C2-level English learners. This assignment focuses on 20 advanced phrasal verbs and idioms, crucial for mastering nuanced and fluent English. The exercises below will test your understanding and ability to use these expressions in context. Complete all tasks within approximately 15 minutes. For the final task, create sentences and record a voice note as instructed.

Part 1: Understanding Phrasal Verbs and Idioms

Below are 20 advanced phrasal verbs and idioms with their meanings. Study them carefully.

1. **Brush up on** – Review or improve a skill.
2. **Clam up** – Become silent or refuse to talk.
3. **Die down** – Gradually decrease or subside.
4. **Fall through** – Fail to happen or be completed.
5. **Give in** – Surrender or agree reluctantly.
6. **Hold off** – Delay or postpone.
7. **Let up** – Become less intense or stop.
8. **Pull off** – Successfully achieve something difficult.
9. **Run into** – Encounter unexpectedly.
10. **See through** – Recognize the truth behind something deceptive.
11. **Bite the bullet** – Face a difficult situation bravely.
12. **Burn the midnight oil** – Work late into the night.
13. **Cut to the chase** – Get to the point quickly.
14. **Hit the nail on the head** – Be exactly correct.
15. **Let the cat out of the bag** – Reveal a secret accidentally.
16. **Piece of cake** – Something very easy.
17. **Pull someone's leg** – Tease or joke with someone.

18. **Spill the beans** – Reveal information unintentionally.
19. **Throw in the towel** – Give up.
20. **Under the weather** – Feeling ill or unwell.

Part 2: Fill-in-the-Blank (5 minutes)

Complete each sentence with the correct phrasal verb or idiom from the list above.

1. I need to _____ my Spanish before the trip to Madrid.
2. The argument was heated, but it began to _____ after an hour.
3. Our plans to buy the house _____ due to financial issues.
4. He was nervous about the presentation, but he _____ and did it.
5. She _____ about the surprise party during lunch.

Part 3: Matching (3 minutes)

Match each phrasal verb or idiom to its correct meaning.

- | | |
|-----------------------------|---|
| 1. Pull off | A. Delay or postpone |
| 2. Clam up | B. Successfully achieve something difficult |
| 3. Hold off | C. Become silent or refuse to talk |
| 4. Piece of cake | D. Something very easy |
| 5. Hit the nail on the head | E. Be exactly correct |

Part 4: Sentence Creation and Voice Note (7 minutes)

For each of the 20 phrasal verbs and idioms listed in Part 1, write one original sentence demonstrating its correct use. Ensure the sentences are varied in context (e.g., professional, casual, academic). After writing, record a voice note reading all 20 sentences clearly and send it to your instructor via email or messaging platform.

Example Sentences:

- Brush up on: I decided to brush up on my coding skills before applying for the tech job.
- Let the cat out of the bag: She let the cat out of the bag about the new product launch.

Instructions for Voice Note:

- Read each sentence slowly and clearly.
- State the number and phrase before each sentence (e.g., "1. Brush up on: [sentence]").
- Ensure the recording is audible and free of background noise.

Submission

Submit your written sentences and voice note to your instructor by October 7, 2025. For feedback, include a brief note on which idioms or phrasal verbs you found most challenging.